Incident Response Management System

Fully Dressed Use Cases – Incident Declaration

Use Case UC1: Declare New Incident

Primary Actor:
Incident Commander / System Operator

Stakeholders and Interests:

- **Responders:** Need clear incident information to begin investigation quickly.
- **Operations Team:** Needs fast declaration of outages to coordinate response.
- **Stakeholders / Management:** Want accurate incident records for communication and postmortems.
- **Customers:** Want incidents to be resolved as quickly as possible.

Preconditions:

- The user is authenticated and has permission to declare incidents.
- The incident response management system is operational.

Success Guarantee:

- A new incident is successfully created and stored in the system with a title and description.
- The incident is visible to relevant responders and teams.

Main Success Scenario:

1. The actor selects the option to declare a new incident.
2. The system displays a form requesting incident information.
3. The actor enters the incident title.
4. The actor enters a description explaining the issue.
5. The actor submits the incident declaration.
6. The system validates the information.

7. The system creates and stores the new incident record.
8. The system confirms the incident has been successfully created.

Extensions:

- 4a. Title field is empty
    - The system prompts the actor to enter a valid title.
- 5a. Description is incomplete
    - The system requests additional details before submission.

Special Requirements:

- Incident creation must occur within seconds to allow rapid response coordination.

Technology and Data Variation List:

- Incident information may be entered via web interface, API, or command-line integration.

Use Case UC2: Assign Incident Severity

Primary Actor:
Incident Commander

Stakeholders and Interests:

- **Operations Team:** Needs correct severity classification to prioritize response.
- **Management:** Needs accurate severity to determine communication level.
- **Customers:** Critical incidents should be resolved faster.

Preconditions:

- An incident has been created in the system.

Success Guarantee:

- The incident is assigned a severity level (Low, Medium, Critical).

Main Success Scenario:

1. The actor opens an incident record.
2. The system displays incident details.
3. The actor selects a severity level.
4. The actor confirms the selection.
5. The system updates the incident severity.
6. The system records the severity change in the incident timeline.

Extensions:

- 3a. Actor selects an invalid severity level
    - The system displays an error message and requests a valid selection.

Special Requirements:

- Severity updates must be immediately visible to all responders.

Technology and Data Variation List:

- Severity levels include predefined categories: Low, Medium, Critical.

Use Case UC3: Categorize Incident Type

Primary Actor:
Incident Commander

Stakeholders and Interests:

- **Engineering Teams:** Need incident categorization to determine the appropriate expertise required.
- **Security Teams:** Need to identify security-related incidents quickly.
- **Operations Management:** Uses incident categories for analysis and reporting.

Preconditions:

- The incident has already been declared.

Success Guarantee:

- The incident is categorized according to type.

Main Success Scenario:

1. The actor views an existing incident.
2. The system displays incident classification options.
3. The actor selects an incident type.
4. The system records the selected category.
5. The system updates the incident metadata.

Extensions:

- 3a. Actor attempts to assign multiple conflicting categories
    - The system requests clarification or allows only one primary category.

Special Requirements:

- Categories must follow predefined types (Outage, Security, Performance, etc.).

Technology and Data Variation List:

- Incident categories may be expanded by system administrators.

Use Case UC4: Assign Initial Responder or Response Team

Primary Actor:
Incident Commander

Stakeholders and Interests:

- **Responders:** Need immediate notification when assigned to incidents.
- **Operations Team:** Needs clear ownership of incidents.
- **Management:** Needs accountability during incident response.

Preconditions:

- An incident has been declared.

- Responders or response teams exist in the system directory.

Success Guarantee:

- The incident is assigned to a responder or response team.

Main Success Scenario:

1. The actor opens the incident record.
2. The actor selects the option to assign a responder or team.
3. The system displays available responders or teams.
4. The actor selects the appropriate responder or team.
5. The system records the assignment.
6. The system notifies the assigned responders.

Extensions:

- 4a. Selected responder is unavailable
    - The system suggests alternative responders or teams.

Special Requirements:

- Assigned responders must receive immediate notification.

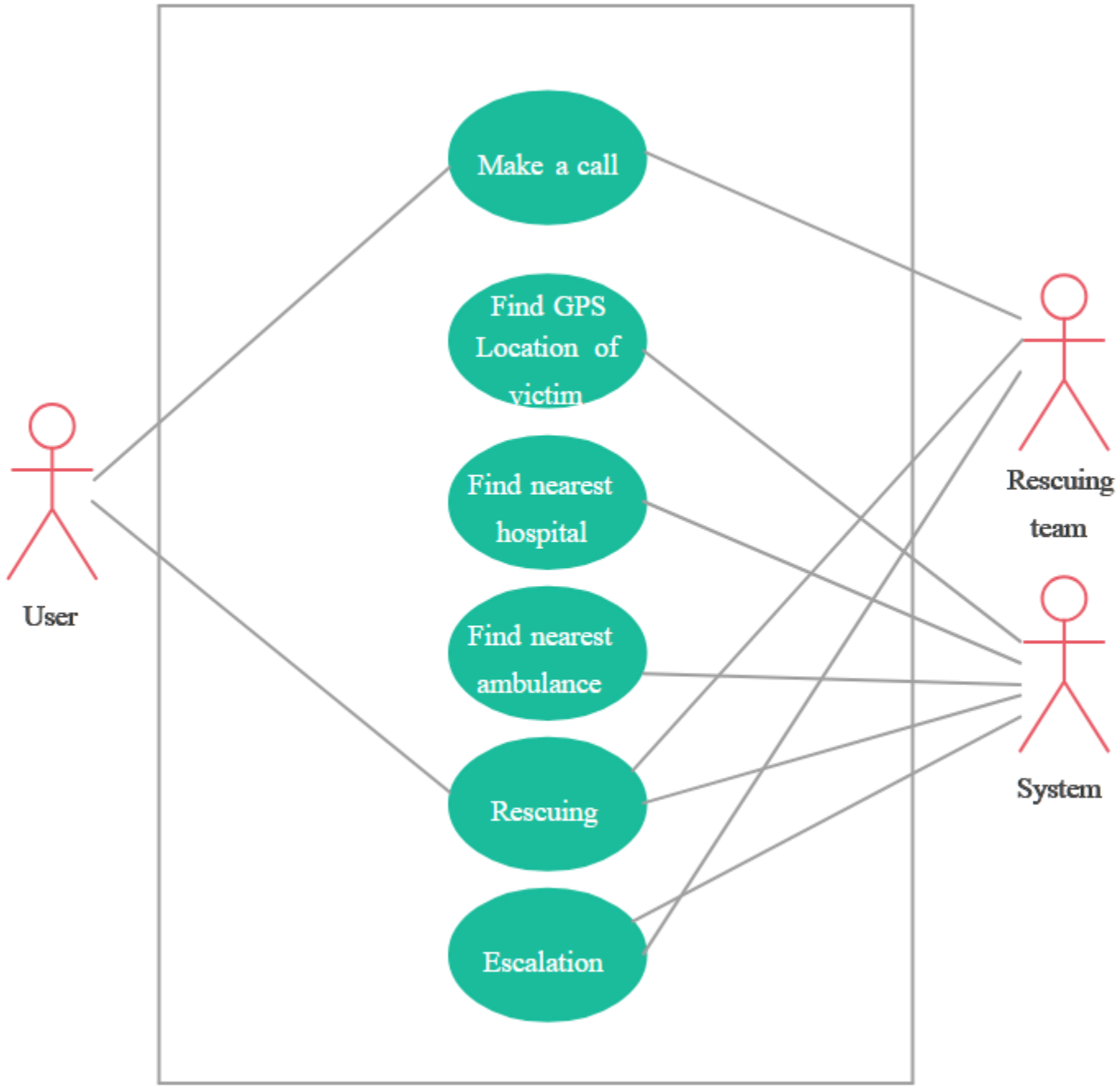
Technology and Data Variation List:

- Notifications may occur through system dashboards, email, or messaging integrations.

Supplementary Specifications (Non-Functional Requirements)

Reliable Incident Data Persistence

The system must reliably persist incident data without confirmed data loss, even during concurrent incident declarations. This ensures that incident records, responder assignments, and severity levels remain consistent and recoverable even when multiple users declare incidents simultaneously.

This non-functional requirement focuses on **data durability, system reliability, and concurrency handling** in the incident management platform.

Use Case Diagram: